

Firearms Trace Data: Arkansas - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Arkansas in Calendar Year 2023

3,539

Firearm Types with an Arkansas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	2,403
Shotguns	525
Rifles	330
Revolvers	187
Machinegun Conversion Devices	33
Machineguns	22
Derringers	14
Other*	25

* Other includes Receivers/Frames, Unknown Types, Any Other Weapons and Silencers.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arkansas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	1,424
12GA	469
.40 Cal	329
.22 Cal	234

.380 Cal	192
.45 Cal	158
MULTI	97
.38 Cal	71
7.62mm	65
5.56mm	53

NOTE: There were 361 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 86 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arkansas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Possession of Weapon	897
Weapon Offense	836
Firearm Under Investigation	434
Found Firearm	321
Dangerous Drugs	255
Aggravated Assault	174
Property Crimes	116
Homicide	91
Suicide	56
Family Offense	54

NOTE: There were 305 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Arkansas	2,026
Texas	152
Missouri	62
Tennessee	57
Oklahoma	53
Mississippi	50
Louisiana	36
Florida	20
Georgia	20
Kentucky	13
Arizona	12
Illinois	12
Kansas	11
Colorado	10
Indiana	10

NOTE: An additional 28 states accounted for 97 other traces. The source state was identified in 2,641 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	199
3 Months to Under 7 Months	162
7 Months to Under 1 Year	186
1 Year to Under 2 Years	407
2 Years to Under 3 Years	376
3 Years and Over	1,306

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Arkansas Average Time-to-Crime: **6.36 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	146
18 to 21	392
22 to 24	308
25 to 30	382
31 to 40	989
41 to 50	375
Over 50	214

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Arkansas Average Age of Possessor: **32 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Little Rock	918
Fort Smith	493
Jonesboro	367
North Little Rock	341
Fayetteville	139
Rogers	134
Texarkana	131
Springdale	120
Hot Springs	93
Conway	84

NOTE: There were 124 additional municipalities that accounted for 719 other traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Arkansas. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Arkansas.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with an Arkansas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arkansas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Arkansas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024